

LIWELILE IMPUMELELO COMMUNITY CENTRE

CHINA PARTNERSHIP RESEARCH LOG

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Prepared by: International Partnerships Coordinator

Status: Active Research Document

SECTION A: RESEARCH STRATEGY OVERVIEW

A1: Target Sectors for China Partnership

Priority	Sector	Focus Area	Rationale
1	Plastic Recycling Technology	Waste-to-value, plastic brick manufacturing	Direct alignment with Programme 4 vision
2	Steel Fabrication	Small-scale manufacturing, equipment	Housing materials, community infrastructure
3	Machinery & Equipment	Appropriate technology for SMMEs	Skills development, local production
4	Construction Materials	Low-cost housing solutions	City of Ekurhuleni partnership potential

A2: Research Channels

Channel	Target	Method	Status
Chinese Embassy Pretoria	Trade/commercial attaché	Formal letter, meeting request	☐
SA-China Business Chamber	Member companies, events	Membership, networking	☐

Channel	Target	Method	Status
Department of Trade, Industry & Competition	China desk	Online research, contact	☐
Online B2B Platforms	Alibaba, Made-in-China	Company research	☐
Industry Publications	Plastics, steel, manufacturing news	Google alerts	☐
Trade Missions	Incoming/outgoing delegations	Monitor DTIC announcements	☐

SECTION B: RELEVANT SEARCH RESULTS – ANALYSIS

B1: China-South Africa Trade & Investment Context

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
Xinhua / China.org.cn (Feb 2026)	China granted duty-free access across 100% of tariff lines for South African exports. Framework Agreement on Economic Partnership signed, with "Early Harvest Agreement" expected by end March 2026. SA experts note this opens doors for accessing manufacturing and services technology.	High – Official government-level commitment to technology transfer; provides policy context for partnership pitches.

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
KBC (Feb 2026)	Deal cushions SA against US tariffs; four pillars: trade cooperation, investment cooperation, new energy collaboration, multilateral coordination. Focus on attracting Chinese investment into automotive, renewable energy, technology.	High – Confirms SA government prioritising Chinese investment; useful for framing proposals.
China Daily (Oct 2025)	New China-Africa Economic and Trade Greater Bay Area International Business Centre launched in Nansha, offering "one-stop" service hub for business matching, legal support, supply chain integration.	Medium – Potential entry point for connections; contact Zhang Yi, Chairman of China-Africa Friendship Economic and Trade Development Commission.

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
Sedna International / b2match (Sept 2025)	Sedna International, a Hong Kong-domiciled company, is building five modular pyrolysis plants in SA (Atlantis, Pretoria, Johannesburg, Durban, second Cape Town). They use continuous-feed pyrolysis technology from Chinese partners Autowei (machines) and Mrs. Bi (construction) , with vendor financing. Converts non-recyclable plastics into oils and	HIGHEST MATCH – A South African company (Sedna) already partnering with Chinese firms Autowei and Mrs. Bi for plastic-to-energy technology. This is a direct case study and potential contact for LICC's China Track. Contact: Linda Mooijman, Chief Growth Officer, Sedna International (Cape Town).

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
	char. Seeking USD 20.6M investment. Partnerships with Waste Group (feedstock) and Nestlé (LOI for fuel). ESG: 500+ tons/day waste diverted, 50+ jobs per site.	

B2: Plastic Recycling / Pyrolysis Technology – DIRECT MATCH

B3: Steel Manufacturing – DIRECT LOCAL MATCH

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
Steel Radar (Aug 2025)	Chinese firm Chung Fung Metal has built a ZAR 2.5 billion steel plant in Nigel, Gauteng (Kaydale industrial zone). Test runs completed, full production imminent. Produces 600,000 tonnes/year of long-steel products using electric arc furnace (EAF) technology – lower carbon emissions. Created 1,000 jobs, targeting 1,200. Water recovery rate 80%, zero liquid discharge target. Well-positioned for transport and distribution.	HIGHEST MATCH – A Chinese steel plant literally in your backyard (Nigel is ~30-40km from Germiston). This is a direct local contact for steel fabrication training, machinery access, and potential partnership. Chung Fung Metal could be approached for site visits, skills transfer, and possibly equipment donations/sponsorship.

B4: Large-Scale Chinese Investment Models

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
Vanguard (March 2026)	Dangote Group (Nigeria) signed US\$4.2 billion, 25-year natural gas supply agreement with China's GCL Group to power US\$2.5 billion urea fertilizer complex in Ethiopia. GCL supplies gas from Calub Gas Field via 108km pipeline. Zhu Gongshan, Chairman of GCL Group, emphasised transition from "business going global" to "mutually beneficial ecosystem-based framework" .	Medium – Demonstrates scale of China-Africa industrial partnerships. GCL Group could be long-term target, but their focus is energy/chemicals, not plastics/steel. Useful for context.

B5: Existing Chinese Operations in South Africa

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
Baowu Steel Group / Sinosteel (Oct 2025)	Sinosteel (subsidiary of China Baowu Steel Group) has operated in SA since 1990s. Samancor Chrome creates over US\$20 billion annual economic value for SA, with 99.5% local employees. In 2024, invested ZAR 8.5 million in education and infrastructure . Liu Dong, Director/General Manager, Sinosteel Overseas Resources, attended SA dialogue.	Medium-High – Major Chinese steel group with decades of SA presence. Potential for corporate social investment partnerships, possibly equipment donations or skills training support. Contact: Liu Dong (Sinosteel).

B6: International Programmes Supporting Plastic Innovation

Source	Key Finding	Relevance to LICC
UNDP (Oct 2024 – Sept 2027)	Global Plastics Innovation Programme (GPIP) operates across China, Nigeria, Sierra Leone, South Africa, Tunisia, Vietnam. Supports innovators, startups, policymakers to co-develop solutions for plastic pollution. Partners: Shenzhen Municipal Government, universities, SMEs, civil society. Promotes South-South cooperation and knowledge exchange.	HIGH – This is an existing funded programme that LICC could potentially tap into. GPIP specifically includes South Africa and China, supports innovators, and promotes knowledge exchange. Contact: UNDP Chemicals & Waste team.

SECTION C: POTENTIAL PARTNERS – SHORTLIST

C1: Highest Priority (Direct Match, Local Presence)

Company/Organisation	Sector	Location	Contact	Partnership Angle	Status
Chung Fung Metal	Steel manufacturing	Nigel, Gauteng	[Research contact]	Site visits, skills training, equipment sponsorship, steel fabrication for housing materials	To Contact

Company/Organisation	Sector	Location	Contact	Partnership Angle	Status
Sedna International	Plastic pyrolysis technology	Cape Town (HQ) + Chinese partners (Autowei, Mrs. Bi)	Linda Mooijman, Chief Growth Officer (linda@sedna.earth)	Learn from their model of partnering with Chinese tech firms; potential introduction to Autowei/ Mrs. Bi	To Contact

C2: High Priority (Established SA Presence, CSR Potential)

Company/Organisation	Sector	Location	Contact	Partnership Angle	Status
Sinosteel / China Baowu Steel Group	Steel manufacturing, mining	South Africa (various)	Liu Dong, Director/General Manager, Sinosteel Overseas Resources	CSR funding, equipment donations, skills training support	To Research

C3: Programme-Level Opportunities

Programme	Focus	Countries	Contact	Opportunity	Status
Global Plastics Innovation Programme (UNDP)	Plastic pollution solutions, innovation support	China, South Africa, Nigeria, Sierra Leone, Tunisia, Vietnam	UNDP Chemicals & Waste team	LICC could apply as an innovator/community organisation; access to Chinese partners, funding, knowledge exchange	To Research Further
China-Africa Economic and Trade Greater Bay Area International Business Center	Business matching, legal support, supply chain	Nansha, China (hub for African partners)	Zhang Yi, Chairman, China-Africa Friendship Economic and Trade Development Commission	One-stop entry point for Chinese business connections	To Contact

C4: Contextual / Long-term Prospects

Organisation	Sector	Relevance	Action
GCL Group	Energy, chemicals	Large-scale Chinese investor in Africa; potential future partner but not immediate fit	Monitor
Chinese Embassy Pretoria	Government	Can facilitate introductions, provide trade delegations information	Formal meeting request

SECTION D: CONTACT STRATEGY

D1: Immediate Actions (Next 30 Days)

Target	Action	Responsible	Deadline	Status
Chung Fung Metal	Research company contact details (phone, email, physical address in Nigel)	Intl Coordinator	31 March 2026	☐
Chung Fung Metal	Draft initial enquiry letter (introducing LICC, expressing interest in site visit and skills training partnership)	Chair + Intl Coordinator	31 March 2026	☐
Sedna International (Linda Mooijman)	LinkedIn connection request with personalised note	Chair	31 March 2026	☐
Sedna International	Follow-up email after connection, expressing interest in learning about their Chinese partnerships	Chair	7 April 2026	☐
UNDP Global Plastics Innovation Programme	Research programme website, identify application process/contact	Intl Coordinator	31 March 2026	☐

D2: Medium-Term Actions (2-3 Months)

Target	Action	Responsible	Timeline
Sinosteel / Baowu	Research CSR contacts; draft proposal for skills training support	Intl Coordinator	April 2026
China-Africa Trade Center (Nansha)	Draft enquiry email to Zhang Yi's office	Chair	April 2026
Chinese Embassy Pretoria	Schedule meeting with trade/commercial attaché	Chair	May 2026
Chung Fung Metal	Site visit (if agreed)	Chair + relevant staff	May 2026

SECTION E: RESEARCH LOG – DETAILED ENTRIES

Entry #001: Chung Fung Metal – Nigel Steel Plant

Field	Details
Date Identified	19 March 2026
Source	SteelRadar article (August 2025)
Company Name	Chung Fung Metal
Sector	Steel manufacturing
Location	Kaydale industrial zone, Nigel, Gauteng (near Germiston)
Key Facts	• ZAR 2.5 billion investment • 600,000 tonnes/year long-steel products

Field	Details
	• Electric arc furnace (lower carbon) • 80% water recovery, zero liquid discharge target • 1,000 jobs created (target 1,200) • Test runs completed, full production imminent
Partnership Potential	• Site visits for LICC members (manufacturing exposure) • Skills training in steel fabrication • Equipment donations/sponsorship for Programme 4 • Potential collaboration on low-cost housing materials
Contact Research Needed	• Phone number • Email address • Physical address for site visit request • Name of General Manager / CSR contact
Action Status	To research contact details
Notes	This is literally a Chinese steel plant in your backyard. Highest priority.

Entry #002: Sedna International – Plastic Pyrolysis with Chinese Partners

Field	Details
Date Identified	19 March 2026
Source	b2match Belt and Road Summit 2025
Company Name	Sedna International
Sector	Plastic waste-to-energy (pyrolysis)

Field	Details
Location	Cape Town (HQ); plants in Atlantis, Pretoria, Johannesburg, Durban, second Cape Town
Chinese Partners	• Autowei (machinery) • Mrs. Bi (construction)
Key Facts	• Hong Kong-domiciled investment and holding company • Technology: continuous-feed pyrolysis – converts non-recyclable plastics into oils and char • Each plant: 42 tons/day oil, 17 tons/day char • 50+ jobs per site • Partnerships: Waste Group (feedstock), Nestlé (LOI for low-sulphur fuel)
Partnership Potential	• Learn from their model of Chinese technology partnership • Potential introduction to Autowei and Mrs. Bi • Knowledge exchange on plastic recycling • Possible collaboration on smaller-scale community plastic recycling
Contact	Linda Mooijman, Chief Growth Officer (linda@sedna.earth)
Action Status	LinkedIn connection to be sent; follow-up email
Notes	This is a direct case study of a South African company successfully partnering with Chinese technology firms. Extremely valuable for LICC's China Track.

Entry #003: Sinosteel / China Baowu Steel Group

Field	Details
Date Identified	19 March 2026

Field	Details
Source	Baowu Steel Group / Sinosteel article (Oct 2025)
Company Name	Sinosteel (subsidiary of China Baowu Steel Group)
Sector	Steel manufacturing, mining
Location	South Africa (various)
Key Facts	• Operating in SA since 1990s • Samancor Chrome: US\$20 billion+ annual economic value • 99.5% local employees • 2024: ZAR 8.5 million invested in education and infrastructure
Partnership Potential	• CSR funding for skills training • Equipment donations • Steel fabrication expertise
Contact	Liu Dong, Director/General Manager, Sinosteel Overseas Resources (attended SA dialogue)
Action Status	To research company, contact details and CSR framework
Notes	Major Chinese player with long SA history and demonstrated CSR commitment.

Entry #004: UNDP Global Plastics Innovation Programme

Field	Details
Date Identified	19 March 2026

Field	Details
Source	UNDP website
Programme Name	Global Plastics Innovation Programme (GPIP)
Implementing Agency	UNDP
Partners	Shenzhen Municipal Government, universities, SMEs, civil society
Participating Countries	China, Nigeria, Sierra Leone, South Africa, Tunisia, Vietnam
Duration	October 2024 – September 2027
Budget	US\$ 1,999,000
Focus	Support innovators, startups, policymakers to co-develop plastic pollution solutions
Activities	• Identify and pilot innovative solutions • Studies on capacity-building • Youth engagement • South-South cooperation, knowledge exchange
Partnership Potential	• LICC could apply as a community innovator • Access to Chinese partners and technology • Potential funding for plastic recycling pilot • Knowledge exchange opportunities
Action Status	To research application process and contact

Field	Details
Notes	This is an existing funded programme specifically designed to connect Chinese and African plastic innovators. Perfect for LICC.

Entry #005: China-Africa Economic and Trade Greater Bay Area International Business Center

Field	Details
Date Identified	19 March 2026
Source	China Daily (Oct 2025)
Center Name	China-Africa Economic and Trade Greater Bay Area International Business Center
Location	Nansha district, Guangzhou, China
Operator	Nansha district government + China-Africa Friendship Economic and Trade Development Commission
Services	"One-stop" service hub: business office, industrial matching, policy consultation, cultural exchange, legal support, supply chain integration, market development
Key Contact	Zhang Yi, Chairman, China-Africa Friendship Economic and Trade Development Commission
Partnership Potential	• Entry point for Chinese business connections • Assistance with partner matching • Legal and market advice • Potential to host LICC profile/information

Field	Details
Action Status	Draft enquiry email to Zhang Yi's office
Notes	Could be a valuable resource for navigating Chinese business partnerships.

SECTION F: CONTACT DETAILS – TO RESEARCH

Organisation	Information Needed
Chung Fung Metal (Nigel)	Phone, email, physical address, General Manager name
Sinosteel South Africa	CSR contact, email, phone
UNDP Global Plastics Innovation Programme	Application process, contact person
China-Africa Friendship Economic and Trade Development Commission	Email for Zhang Yi's office
Chinese Embassy Pretoria	Trade/commercial attaché contact

SECTION G: RESEARCH LOG MAINTENANCE

Action	Frequency	Responsible
Update contact details	As discovered	Intl Coordinator
Log new outreach attempts	Weekly	Intl Coordinator

Action	Frequency	Responsible
Record responses	Immediate	Intl Coordinator
Review priority list	Monthly	Chair + Intl Coordinator
Add new search results	Ongoing	Intl Coordinator

SECTION H: NEXT STEPS SUMMARY

#	Action	Target	Deadline
1	Research Chung Fung Metal contact details	Chung Fung Metal	31 March 2026
2	LinkedIn connection to Linda Mooijman (Sedna)	Sedna International	31 March 2026
3	Research UNDP GPIP application process	UNDP	31 March 2026
4	Draft enquiry email to Chung Fung Metal	Chung Fung Metal	7 April 2026
5	Follow-up email to Linda Mooijman	Sedna International	7 April 2026

END OF CHINA PARTNERSHIP RESEARCH LOG